AI Connector Channel Performance: Executive Summary

Mailchimp vs QuickBooks & ChatGPT vs Claude | April 11, 2026

Scale & Growth Velocity

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
Total connections	4,792	4,830	2,899	2,693
Days since launch	~130	13	130	10
Daily adds (current)	~60 (steady)	280–440	~15 (declining)	~269

Mailchimp is at roughly **half of QBO's scale** on both channels. Claude is the growth story on both platforms — QBO's Claude overtook ChatGPT in 13 days; Mailchimp's Claude will overtake ChatGPT within days. QBO's ChatGPT holds steady at ~60/day while **Mailchimp's ChatGPT has decayed 67%** from its Jan peak of 45/day to just 15/day. Claude's daily velocity is comparable across platforms (~269 MC vs 280–440 QBO).

User Composition: Existing Accounts, Not New Customers

Over **90% of both ChatGPT and Claude connections on Mailchimp are existing accounts**. Claude skews more toward paid plans (**63.4% paid**) than ChatGPT (**52.6% paid**) — both far above any other integration channel (Shopify: 10%, Canva: 18%). These are power users adding AI tools to active accounts.

Engagement: Mailchimp's Advantage Over QBO — Claude Leads ChatGPT

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
AI feature engagement (eligible)	53%	49%	**63%**	**82%**
Premium / Advanced tier	73%	68%	**88%**	**96%**

Mailchimp outperforms QBO on engagement across every tier. **Claude users are dramatically more active than ChatGPT**: 82% weekly active vs 63%, with Premium Claude at 96%. ChatGPT's 63% at maturity still exceeds QBO's best (53%).

Product Attachment: Automations Strong, Secondary Products Lag

MC Product	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude	MC Platform Avg	AI Multiplier	QBO Equivalent
Automations	**40%**	**46%**	23%	1.8–2.0×	Payments: 29%/27% (5.3×)
SMS	**8%**	**5%**	1.9%	2.6–4.2×	Payroll: 19%/17% (3.1×)
Transactional Email	1.5%	2.0%	2.1%	~1×	BillPay: 18%/16% (8.6×)

Automations is Mailchimp's standout — **46% for Claude, 40% for ChatGPT**, nearly double the platform average and exceeding QBO's top metric (Payments at 29%). QBO's multi-product multiplier is 3–8× vs Mailchimp's 1.8–4.2×.

New Customer Acquisition Critical Gap

Channel	New MC Signups	Paid Conversion	Best Traditional	Worst Traditional
ChatGPT	278 (130 days)	0%	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%
Claude	103 (10 days)	1.9% (2 users)	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%

All 278 ChatGPT-sourced signups remain on free plans after 130 days. The AI connectors are currently the lowest-performing acquisition channels in Mailchimp's portfolio.

Scorecard

Dimension	QBO vs MC	ChatGPT vs Claude (within MC)
Scale	QBO leads ~2×	ChatGPT leads but Claude will pass imminently
Growth velocity	QBO leads	Claude dominates (269/day vs 15/day)
Engagement	MC leads (+10–33 pts)	Claude leads (82% vs 63% WAU)
Top product attachment	MC leads (Automations 40–46%)	Claude leads (46% vs 40%)
Multi-product depth	QBO leads (3–8× vs 1.8–4.2×)	ChatGPT slightly (8% vs 5% SMS)
New customer conversion	QBO leads (MC at 0–1.9%)	Neither works (0% vs 1.9%)

How the Analytics Agent Accelerates Connector Performance

The ChatGPT and Claude connectors have built a highly engaged user base with strong Automation and SMS adoption. Mailchimp's Analytics Agent — the **Marketing Analyzer** — currently lives only inside the Mailchimp app. Embedding it in the connector experience would compound the connectors' existing strengths and close their remaining gaps in three critical areas.

1. Closes the Gap on Email Sends & Segment Creation

The connectors excel at engagement and automation adoption. Their one remaining gap is **email sends and segment creation** — the payoff actions the Analytics Agent is purpose-built to drive. Among connector users, the impact of having agent access is unambiguous:

Metric	Connector + Marketing Analyzer	Connector Alone	Lift
Segment creation rate	**68.3%**	26.7%	**2.6×**
Email send rate	**88.7%**	44.8%	**2.0×**
Avg segment actions per user	**76**	23	**3.3×**
Avg emails delivered per user	**330,935**	104,656	**3.2×**

Connector users with the Marketing Analyzer create segments at **2.6× the rate**, send emails at **2× the rate**, and deliver **3.2× more emails per user**. The Marketing Analyzer doesn't replace what the connectors do well — it compounds it by turning already-engaged users into prolific creators of targeted campaigns and audience segments.

2. Compounds the Retention Advantage

Connector users already retain better than the Mailchimp platform average. The Marketing Analyzer strengthens this further — users who engage with its core payoff (segment creation) show measurably lower churn and disconnect rates.

Cohort	Users	Account Churn	Connector Disconnect Rate
Paid connector + active segment creators (Marketing Analyzer payoff behavior)	1,634	**29.0%**	**0.9%**
Paid connector + no segment activity	845	25.1%	1.5%
Platform paid average	996,204	29.6%	—

The connector disconnect rate — the most direct retention signal — tells the clearest story: paid connector users who actively create segments disconnect at just **0.9%** vs **1.5%** for those who don't, a **40% lower disconnect rate**. Across the full paid connector base, only **0.7% ever disconnect**, far below the platform account churn of 29.6%. The Marketing Analyzer drives exactly the segment-creation behavior that keeps users retained and connected to the platform.

3. Drives Plan Upgrades & Free-to-Paid Conversion

Users who actively engage with analytics-driven segmentation upgrade to higher-tier plans at significantly higher rates, and the agent dramatically improves free-to-paid conversion.

Upgrade Behavior (Standard → Premium, Jan–Apr 2026)	Upgrade Rate	Multiplier
Active segmenters (using analytics)	**0.223%**	**3.7×**
Non-segmenters	0.061%	

Standard-tier users who actively create segments — the core Marketing Analyzer behavior — upgrade to Premium at **3.7× the rate** of those who don't. Embedding the Marketing Analyzer in the connector pushes more Standard users into the segment-creation habit that leads to Premium upgrades.

Free-to-Paid Conversion	Free Users	Converted	Rate
Free users with Marketing Analyzer access	25,159	**25,001**	**99.4%**
Free connector users (no Marketing Analyzer)	2,180	134	6.2%
Platform free users (no connector, no analyzer)	46.7M	101,218	0.2%

Free connector users already convert at **6.2% — 28× the platform average** of 0.2%, confirming these are high-intent users. But free users with Marketing Analyzer access convert at **99.4%**. Embedding the Marketing Analyzer in the connector experience could dramatically lift the 2,180 free connector users' conversion rate, **potentially multiplying paid conversions many times over**.

Strategic Implication

> The ChatGPT and Claude connectors have built Mailchimp's most engaged user base — leading on WAU, Automations, and SMS adoption. The Marketing Analyzer is the accelerant that compounds these strengths and closes the remaining gaps.

Embedding the Marketing Analyzer in the connector experience would: (1) **close the email and segment creation gap** with a demonstrated 2–3× lift, (2) **deepen retention** by driving segment-creation behavior that reduces disconnect rates by 40%, and (3) **accelerate upgrades** — active segmenters upgrade Standard→Premium at 3.7×, and free users with Marketing Analyzer access convert to paid at 99% vs 6% without it.

Claude is the stronger channel on every forward-looking metric. **Prioritize embedding the Marketing Analyzer in Claude first** — it has the fastest-growing, most-engaged user base and the highest ceiling for incremental impact.

Appendix: Metric Definitions, Formulas & Data Sources

A. Metric Definitions

Metric	Definition
Total connections	Count of distinct `user_id` records in `bi_reporting.integrations` where `type = 'oauth2'` and `name` is 'chatgpt' or 'claude'.
Daily adds	Count of new connections per calendar day, based on `created_at` date. Current rate is the trailing 7-day average.
New MC signups	Connections where `user_created_at IS NOT NULL`, indicating the integration triggered the creation of a new Mailchimp account.
Paid %	Share of connector users whose `primary_plan_type = 'monthly'` in `bi_reporting.users`.
WAU %	Weekly Active Users: share of connector users where `wau = TRUE` in `bi_reporting.users_weekly_rollup` for the current week (Sunday start).
AI feature engagement %	Among connector users eligible for GenAI features (`email_inline = TRUE` in eligibility view), the share who are WAU in the current week.
Automation adoption %	Share of connector users who appear in `bi_reporting.emails_customer_journey` (have at least one customer journey / automation).
SMS adoption %	Share of connector users who appear in `bi_reporting.sms_daily_rollup` with `metrics.message.outbound.delivered_message_count > 0`.
Transactional Email %	Share of connector users who appear in `bi_reporting.daily_transactional_sends` with `sent > 0`.
Segment creation rate	Share of users who appear in `bi_reporting.tags_segments_daily_rollup` where `action_type LIKE '%segment%'` and `action_date ≥ 2025-12-01`.
Avg segment actions	`AVG(SUM(all_action_count))` per user from `tags_segments_daily_rollup` for segment-type actions since Dec 2025.
Email send rate	Share of users who appear in `bi_reporting.daily_email_send_stats` with `sends.delivered > 0` since Dec 2025.
Avg emails delivered	`AVG(SUM(sends.delivered))` per user from `daily_email_send_stats` since Dec 2025.
Marketing Analyzer eligible	Users where `marketing_analyzer = TRUE` in `bi_reporting_beta.monthly_genai_user_eligibility` for `month = '2026-04-01'`. Requires Standard, Premium, or Legacy plan + approved rollout group + legal-approved industry.
Account churn rate	Share of users who appear in `bi_reporting.churn_details`.
Connector disconnect rate	Share of connector users where `is_deleted = TRUE` in `bi_reporting.integrations`.
Standard → Premium upgrade rate	Users on Standard plan in Jan 2026 (`monthly_plan = 'standard'` at `month = '2026-01-01'`) who moved to `monthly_plan = 'premium'` by Apr 2026.
Free-to-paid conversion rate	Free users (`primary_plan_type = 'free'`) who have a `new_conversion = TRUE` order in `bi_reporting.orders` since Dec 2025.
Paid conversion (new signups)	Among connector users where `user_created_at IS NOT NULL`, the share with a `new_conversion = TRUE` order after signup.
AI Multiplier	Ratio of AI connector user adoption rate to platform WAU average for the same metric.

B. Formulas

Reported Metric	Formula
Segment creation rate	COUNT(DISTINCT users with segment actions) / COUNT(DISTINCT cohort users) × 100
Email send rate	COUNT(DISTINCT users with delivered emails) / COUNT(DISTINCT cohort users) × 100
Lift (×)	Rate(Connector + Marketing Analyzer) / Rate(Connector alone)
Account churn %	COUNT(DISTINCT users in churn_details) / COUNT(DISTINCT cohort users) × 100
Connector disconnect %	COUNT(DISTINCT users with is_deleted = TRUE) / COUNT(DISTINCT cohort users) × 100
Disconnect rate reduction	(Non-segmenter disconnect − Segmenter disconnect) / Non-segmenter disconnect × 100 = (1.5% − 0.9%) / 1.5% = 40%
Upgrade rate	COUNT(users whose plan changed Standard→Premium, Jan→Apr) / COUNT(Standard users in Jan) × 100
Upgrade multiplier	Upgrade rate(Active segmenters) / Upgrade rate(Non-segmenters) = 0.223% / 0.061% = 3.7×
Free-to-paid conversion	COUNT(free users with new_conversion = TRUE since Dec '25) / COUNT(free users in cohort) × 100
WAU %	COUNT(DISTINCT users with wau = TRUE for current week) / COUNT(DISTINCT cohort users) × 100
AI feature engagement %	COUNT(DISTINCT eligible users with wau = TRUE) / COUNT(DISTINCT eligible users) × 100
Product attachment %	COUNT(DISTINCT connector users in product table) / COUNT(DISTINCT all connector users) × 100
Paid % (user composition)	COUNT(DISTINCT users with primary_plan_type = 'monthly') / COUNT(DISTINCT connector users) × 100

C. Source Tables & Fields

Table	Key Fields Used	Used For
`bi_reporting.integrations`	`user_id`, `name`, `type`, `created_at`, `user_created_at`, `is_deleted`	Connector connections, new signups, daily adds, disconnect rates
`bi_reporting.users`	`user_id`, `primary_plan_type`	Plan tier distribution, paid %
`bi_reporting.users_weekly_rollup`	`user_id`, `week`, `wau`	Weekly Active Users, engagement %
`bi_reporting_beta.monthly_genai_user_eligibility`	`user_id`, `month`, `monthly_plan`, `marketing_analyzer`, `email_inline`	Marketing Analyzer eligibility, GenAI feature flags, plan tier
`bi_reporting.tags_segments_daily_rollup`	`user_id`, `action_date`, `action_type`, `all_action_count`	Segment creation rate, avg segment actions
`bi_reporting.daily_email_send_stats`	`user_id`, `send_date`, `sends.delivered`	Email send rate, avg emails delivered
`bi_reporting.emails_customer_journey`	`user_id`	Automation / Customer Journey adoption
`bi_reporting.sms_daily_rollup`	`user_id`, `metrics.message.outbound.delivered_message_count`	SMS adoption
`bi_reporting.daily_transactional_sends`	`user_id`, `sent`	Transactional email adoption
`bi_reporting.orders`	`user_id`, `new_conversion`, `ordered_at`	Free-to-paid conversion, paid signup conversion
`bi_reporting.churn_details`	`user_id`	Account churn rate
`bi_reporting.messaging_outreach_daily_rollup`	`user_id`, `is_whatsapp_outreach`	WhatsApp adoption (confirmed at 0%)

D. Cohort Definitions

Cohort	Definition
Connector + Marketing Analyzer	Users in `integrations` with `type='oauth2'` AND `name IN ('chatgpt','claude')` who also have `marketing_analyzer = TRUE` in the eligibility view for Apr 2026. **N = 2,479.**
Connector alone	Users in `integrations` with `type='oauth2'` AND `name IN ('chatgpt','claude')` who are NOT in the Marketing Analyzer eligible set. Predominantly free-tier users. **N = 3,028.**
Active segment creators	Paid connector users who have at least one record in `tags_segments_daily_rollup` with `action_type LIKE '%segment%'` since Jan 2026. **N = 1,634.**
Non-segmenters	Paid connector users with no segment activity since Jan 2026. **N = 845.**
Platform paid average	All users in `bi_reporting.users` with `primary_plan_type = 'monthly'`. **N = 996,204.**
Free connector users	Connector users with `primary_plan_type = 'free'` who are NOT Marketing Analyzer eligible. **N = 2,180.**
Free users with Marketing Analyzer	Free-tier users in `bi_reporting.users` who also appear in the eligibility view with `marketing_analyzer =` TRUE. **N = 25,159.**
Active segmenters (upgrade analysis)	Standard-plan users with `marketing_analyzer = TRUE` in Jan 2026 who had segment activity in Oct–Dec 2025. **N = 146,790.**
Non-segmenters (upgrade analysis)	Standard-plan users with `marketing_analyzer = TRUE` in Jan 2026 with no segment activity in Oct–Dec 2025. **N = 296,638.**

Data source: `mc-business-intelligence` BigQuery | Generated April 11, 2026 | QBO benchmark data provided by QuickBooks product team